

news feed

DIGIT MARCH 2002

hypethesis

■ What is Lindows?

Lindows is a Linux-based operating system that can run both Linux and Windows applications. It's a move towards bringing Linux to the desktop and getting more users use the Linux OS.

■ Why is it popular?

All popular Windows applications such as MS Office will run on the Lindows platform. Full compatibility would be achieved within a year for all popular Windows applications. It's in the news not only because of its functionality in running Windows applications, but also due to the fact that Microsoft is up against Lindows to withdraw its brand name, as it rhymes with Windows!

■ When will it be released?

The preview version has been released with the commercial version available for \$99. Visit www.lindows.com for more information.

snapshot

Only **2%** of Indian Net users shop online compared to a global average of **31%**

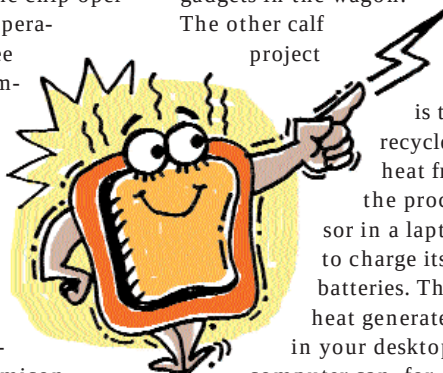
Source: NASSCOM

Morphing Heat into Electricity

MIT has developed a microchip which can transform heat into electricity. Undergoing tests currently, the chip operates at a low temperature of 200 degree centigrade as compared to vacuum tube electrodes that require 1000 degree centigrade to produce a miniscule current. The Indium antimonide-based semiconductor would be induced for a scattering chain reaction that would turn heat into

current. The inventors are aiming at tapping heat from the car's engine to provide electricity to other electronic gadgets in the wagon.

The other calf project



is to recycle heat from

the processor in a laptop to charge its batteries. The heat generated in your desktop

computer can, for example, be used to power a CD-ROM drive or to amplify the sound of the speakers.

Supermarket Navigator

If you've ever stood in the middle of the supermarket aisle, confused and wondering about your shopping list, then maybe the Klever-Kart will be useful. This is an electronic gadget attached to your shopping basket and its purpose is to inform you about the products in the shopping mall. So if you missed that raspberry jam, it will tell you where it is. With customer



loyalty cards inserted into the Klever-Kart system, this supermarket navigator identifies the user handling the basket

and provides personalised

information to aid shopping. These cards track what product and brand a customer buys as well as factors such as where, when and how much money a

customer spends. Call it convenience or call it snooping—the result is helping you shop. Or is it really?

PSX finally arrives

The PSX is the first PlayStation console to be launched in India, with a partnership between Sony India and Milestone Interactive. The console is available in retail at an asking price of Rs 7,990, including the Dualshock analog controller and a complementary game. The PSX, first introduced in 1995, has sold around 88 million consoles worldwide.

End of Spam?

Truste, a non-profit organisation, and Eprivacy Inc have launched a service called Positiva aimed at combating spam. The group is negotiating with e-mail program creators to introduce a new concept to stop spam. And what's the concept? Eliminating spammers from legitimate commercial mail by attaching digital signatures with the e-mail sent by any user. This way, the e-mail service providers can automatically eliminate spam mail from legitimate commercial mail. Companies have to register with the group to get the hardware device that attaches the digital signature to the e-mail. Microsoft is the first company to endorse this service and is trying to implement spam-free mail service for MSN users. But would this move really translate into the end of all spam, even if consumers pay extra?

■ 37 million Americans trade music files ■ IBM discontinues Thinkpad Transnote ■ MIT institutes Dewang Mehta award for innovations in IT